

FEDERAL UNIVERSITY OYE-EKITI (FUOYE)

SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTISING EFFECTIVENESS

Undergraduate platform usage, engagement, perceived effectiveness, and challenges with social media advertising

414 VALID RESPONSES • DESCRIPTIVE SURVEY ANALYSIS

What This Analysis Covers

- Social media platforms most used for advertisement among FUOYE undergraduates
- Frequency of engagement with social media adverts
- Perceived effectiveness of social media advertising
- Challenges undergraduates face with social media adverts
- Recommendations for improving social media advertisement

PERCEIVED EFFECTIVENESS

2.99

out of 4

**Grand Mean —
Advertising Effectiveness**

Social media adverts are perceived as effective, especially for product discovery

SAMPLE PROFILE

Who Responded

A diverse, digitally active sample across gender, age, and level of study

414

Valid Responses

61.1%

Female
Respondents

59.2%

Aged 21–25

53.6%

400 Level Students

99.8%

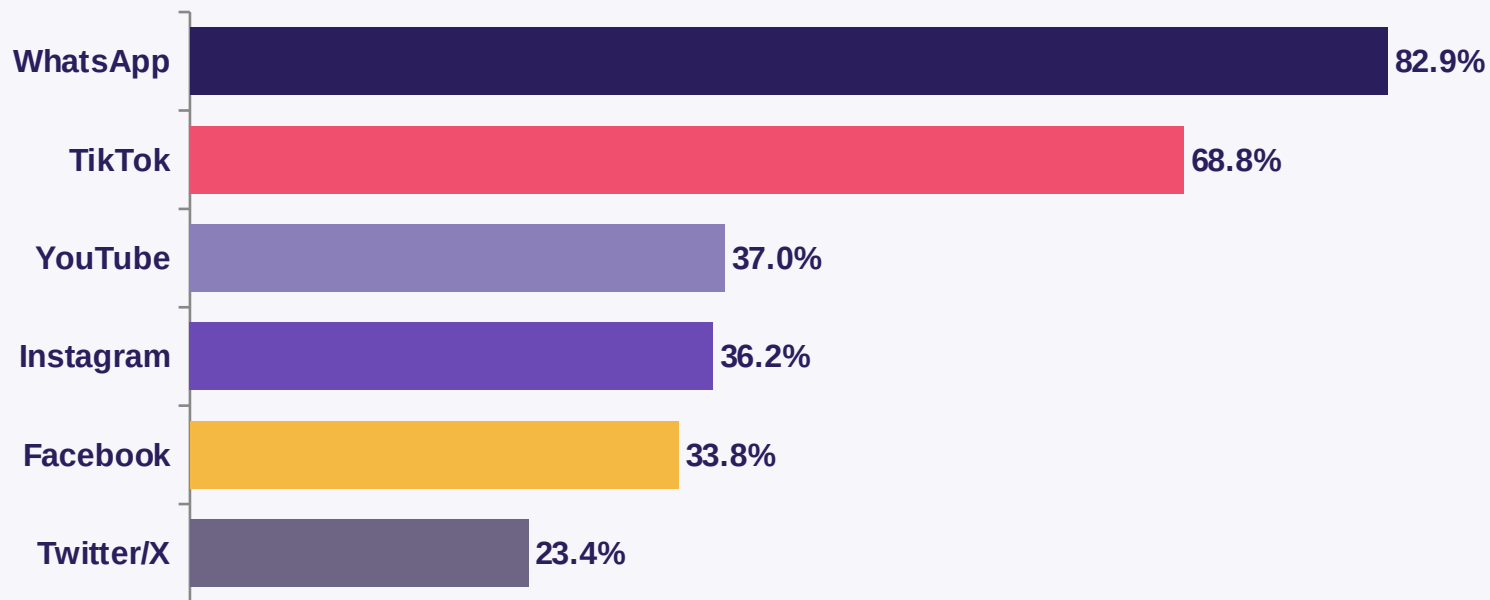
Active Social Media
Users

Respondents spanned 100–500 Level and 10 broad faculty groupings, confirming the sample's suitability for a study on social media advertisement.

RESEARCH QUESTION ONE

Which Platforms Do Undergraduates Use Most?

Share of respondents selecting each platform (multiple responses permitted, N = 414)



KEY INSIGHT

Popularity, Ad Exposure, and Usefulness Diverge

Overall platform popularity does not automatically translate into advertising effectiveness

MOST USED OVERALL

82.9%

WhatsApp

Dominates everyday platform use
among FUOYE undergraduates

HEAVIEST AD EXPOSURE

34.1%

YouTube

Highest share of respondents see the
most adverts here

MOST USEFUL FOR ADS

46.4%

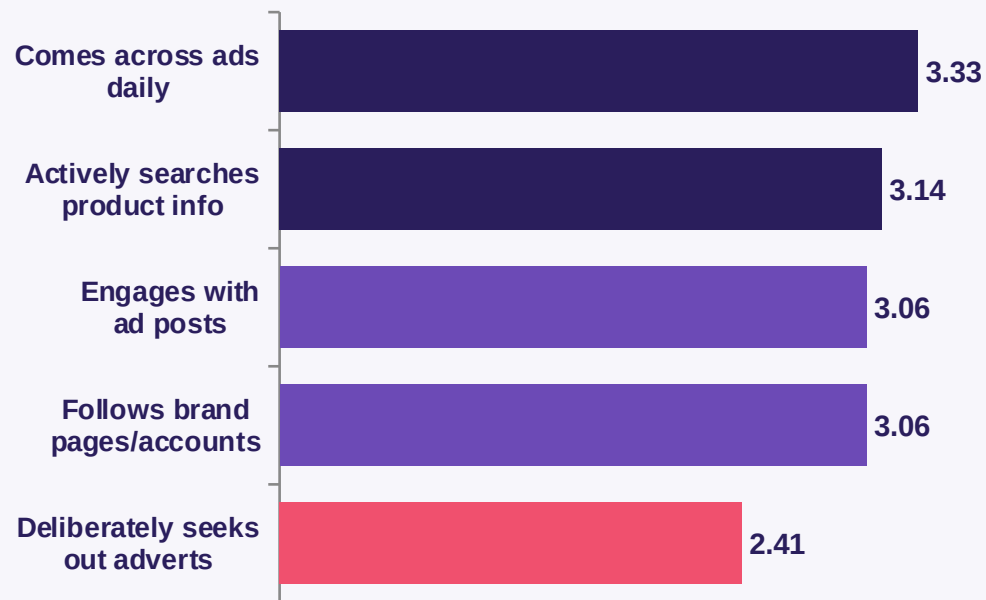
TikTok

Regarded as the most useful platform
for advertisement by far

RESEARCH QUESTION TWO

How Often Do Students Engage with Ads?

Mean scores on a 4-point frequency scale (grand mean = 3.00, accepted)



PASSIVE, NOT PROACTIVE

Only 1 item was rejected across the entire study — this one.

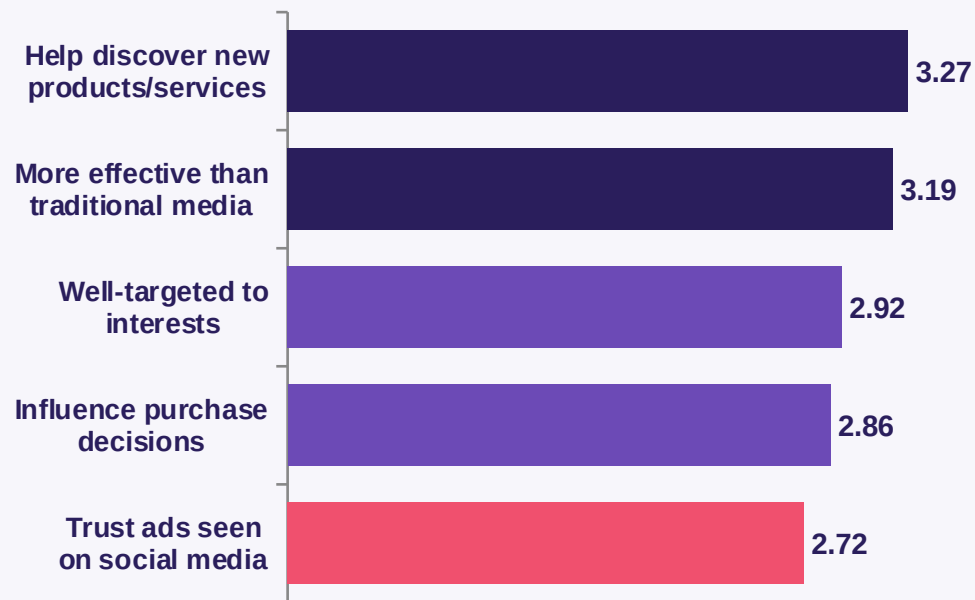
Students encounter ads daily and often search for product info, but rarely go online specifically to seek out adverts (mean = 2.41).

Exposure is largely incidental — a by-product of platforms used for communication and entertainment.

RESEARCH QUESTION THREE

Is Social Media Advertising Effective?

Mean scores on a 4-point agreement scale (grand mean = 2.99, accepted)



THE TRUST GAP

2.72 / 4

Lowest-rated item in this set —
trust in social media adverts

Students value adverts for discovery and rate them above traditional media, but real scepticism about credibility persists.

RESEARCH QUESTION FOUR

What Challenges Do Students Face?

Mean scores on a 4-point agreement scale (grand mean = 2.82, all accepted)



Content-quality concerns (misleading ads, ad fatigue) edge out structural/economic barriers (connectivity, cost) as the more pressing challenge.

RESEARCH QUESTION FIVE

What Improvements Do Students Want?

Mean scores on a 4-point agreement scale — the highest-rated item set in the entire study (grand mean = 3.19)



RECOMMENDATIONS

For Advertisers & Businesses

01

Prioritise WhatsApp & TikTok in Media Planning

These platforms dominate usage among FUOYE undergraduates; also leverage YouTube for reach given its high concentration of ad exposure.

02

Verify Product Authenticity Before Promotion

Misleading content was the most strongly affirmed challenge (mean = 2.88) and directly undermines the trust needed to convert exposure into purchases.

03

Invest in Precise Audience Targeting

Respondents identified excessive, poorly matched adverts as a source of disruption and ad fatigue; sharper targeting reduces irrelevant content.

RECOMMENDATIONS

For Regulators, Platforms & Institutions

04

Strengthen Regulatory Oversight (ARCON)

Curb misleading and fake advertisement content directed at students, in line with the strong support respondents expressed for stricter regulation.

05

Improve Sponsored Content Transparency

Clearer labelling of adverts and easier reporting mechanisms for misleading posts can help rebuild the moderate trust students currently place in social media ads.

06

Expand Internet Access & Digital Literacy

Subsidised campus data plans and university-led digital literacy initiatives address connectivity costs and help students verify advertised products.

CONCLUSION & CALL TO ACTION

- Social media advertising is pervasive and fairly effective, particularly for product discovery and comparison with traditional media
- Exposure is largely incidental — a by-product of platforms used for communication, not deliberate ad-seeking
- Credibility concerns and access/cost barriers are the two forces holding back its full potential

HIGHEST-PRIORITY ASK

Verify Products Before Promotion

Students' top-rated recommendation — mean = 3.32/4

BUILD ON STRENGTH

Invest Deeper in TikTok

Rated most useful for advertisement despite not carrying the highest exposure

Addressing credibility and access barriers together — not in isolation — is essential to unlocking social media advertising's full potential for this audience.